

What is Networking?

Learning Objectives

- Define computer networking and its purpose
- Identify real-world examples of networks
- Explain how devices communicate through a network

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Imagine the bus route system in your town. Buses connect different areas—school, market, hospital—so people and messages can travel. A computer network works the same way: it connects computers so information can travel between them.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Draw a simple diagram of your school computer lab. How many computers are there? Are they connected to each other or to a printer? Write down what you think happens when you print a document from one computer.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

A computer network is a group of two or more computers connected together to share data, files, and resources. Networks can be small, like two computers in a room, or huge, like the internet connecting the whole world. The main purpose of networking is communication and resource sharing.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think of your hostel or home. If two siblings want to share a photo, they might pass a phone around. Now imagine five computers connected—they can share the same printer, internet connection, and files instantly without passing anything around. Name three things a network could share in your classroom.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: In one sentence, define what a computer network is. Then name one thing a network helps us share. If you finish early, draw a picture of two computers connected by a cable.